

In 2011, with a budget of 5000 pounds, they designed SULSA, a drone and because it was 3D printed, they were able to give it a far more complicated aerodynamic structure that would have cost a fortune to build using conventional methods. Thus 3D printing, only on a larger scale could allow the execution of certain designs that would have been overlooked due to cost and manufacturing methods.

Just like the SULSA, 2011 marked out to be the year of 3D printed firsts with funny names as the next innovation was titled the Urbee. Urbee is the greenest car on earth and with figures of over 200 miles to the gallon, gives the Tata Nano a run for its money. Since conventional methods of manufacture were too labour and time intensive. So they split the car in to 10 printable parts and soon, the world's first 3D printed car was ready once again questioning how relevant traditional supply chains models and assembly lines will be in the future.

With 2011 and 2012 being productive years that were more or less non controversial, 2013 however saw the design, production of the world's first 3d printed gun. Dubbed the Liberator, it paid homage to the one shot guns that were designed to be air dropped over Nazi occupied France during the Second World War.



Are we there yet?

But the similarities stopped there because the Liberator of 2013 had a total of 16 working parts out of which 15 were made of plastic. The brainchild of Cody Wilson, a 25 year old law student from the University of Texas envisioned that the gun's schematics would be freely available to download off the internet promising anybody with a 3D printer and an internet connection with a gun.

Cody Wilson didn't just stop there. Through his company - Defence Distributed, Cody applied for a firearms manufacturing license. His next project was the 3D printed 'lower' of an AR-15 assault rifle, the part which actually meets the requirements of an object to be classified as a gun. This means that the stock, barrel and all other parts could be ordered online by anybody. While Cody Wilson has been included in Wired's list of the 15 most dangerous people in the world, it only goes to show that there can be